



Ipod Mini

Apple has launched the long-rumoured iPad Mini, along with a brand new iMac and more affordable Retina-enabled Macbooks



Google sued

Google has been sued in Delaware, USA, for alleged infringement of a US Patent by its Google Wallet smartphone application

G400, G500 and G9x, all excellent mice and available in every price bracket.

These mice are well-built and though not in the same



Logitech G400

league as the offerings from Corsair, make quite a good case for themselves. We've had the G500 and G9x for over a year now and we've grown to really like them. The G9x can be considered, in some ways, as the ultimate gaming mouse, having every feature under the sun, including free-wheel and ratcheted mode for the scroll wheel and even interchangeable bodies. The price is a bit steep we feel, but acceptable considering the features on offer. The same goes for the G500 and while it doesn't have interchangeable bodies and is quite large, it is also very comfortable and was our favourite mouse till the M90 came along.

The G300 and G400 are excellent entry-level gaming mice and are good deals at the price. Nothing exciting to report here other than the fact that the G400 claims to be the new MX518 (a true classic) and the G300 looks a bit funky in our opinion. All the mice track well and are quite precise.

Verdict: These are all excellent deals at any budget and you really can't go wrong with any of these products. Highly recommended products.

KEYBOARDS

It is hard to sell a good keyboard to a gamer, for true gaming you really need a mechanical keyboard, or at least, that is what the gaming pundits claim. After trying out the handful of mechanical keyboards that we got, we still can't say for sure. Granted they're supposed to last much longer and yes, the Angry German kid would probably break his desk before he dented such a keyboard, but the high price doesn't justify the improvement in the feel unless you're a pro. In fact, the ₹275 worth Zebronic Judwaa keyboard that we received a year ago seemed as relevant as the Logitech G19 was at more than 40 times the price.

We will say that the feel of a mechanical keyboard is very different from that of a regular



Steelseries 7G

keyboard and that it does take some getting used to, especially for typing, where we found that we were, on average, 10 words per minute slower with mechanical keyboards than with regular keyboards. These keyboards are something of a niche product but we cannot definitively recommend them over a regular keyboard.

Mechanical keyboards are very nice to use however once you get the hang of them, and the almost pre-cognitive response of the keys (due to a shorter travel) is a pleasure to use after one gets used to it.

Things to look for on a keyboard are nKRO (for keyboard heavy games such as RPGs and MMOs; also known as n Key Roll Over, a game mode (not a requisite but nice to have) and the ability to program on the fly macros. Additional macro keys and profile modes are a bonus.

Steelseries

We received the 6Gv2 and 7G mechanical keyboards from Steelseries and they are good keyboards for sure. The 7G sets itself apart by offering an almost infinite KRO which is quite amazing considering that most keyboards offer something in the range of 5 KRO. We don't really know how useful this is as pressing more than 5 keys simultaneously usually means you're bashing your head on the keyboard rather than consciously deciding

to execute more than 5 different keystrokes at once. The keyboard also features USB ports and audio passthrough. A nice addition if you don't like clutter.

The 6Gv2 is the younger brother of the 7G and is identical except for missing USB ports, audio jacks and palm rest. Both the keyboards feature an unusually placed "Steelseries" key, which replaces the left Windows key on a regular keyboard. This can get quite frustrating during regular use, but is meant for gamers who do not want to inadvertently press the Windows key in the heat of the

battle. We would have preferred a game-mode switch though.

Verdict: Both are excellent keyboards and are essentially



CM Storm Trigger

identical. If you're willing to spend above ₹8,000 on just a keyboard, you can't really go wrong with these.

Cooler Master

More mechanical keyboards here, namely the QuickFire Pro, TK and Storm Trigger. The TK is a compact keyboard and feels a bit cramped for normal use. The insert, home, delete keys, etc. are gone and replaced by the NumPad and so are the arrow keys, which double-up as the bottom half of the NumPad when NumLock is on. The keyboard is quite tall and we would have liked a palm-rest to go with it. The PRO is the full-sized version of the TK with similar ergonomics. We noticed that the PRO has a toggle-able fn key which is a nice touch as many of the function keys double as media keys.

The Storm Trigger was the most comfortable keyboard we got and though the keys were supposedly identical to those on the PRO and TK (Cherry MX red), they did feel a bit soft. Also, this keyboard requires external power if you are thinking of utilizing the USB ports.

Verdict: As with the Steelseries, these are all good keyboards and we can't really decide between them. Though if we're pushed for a decision, we would say the Storm Trigger would be